

1938, July 18

The following is a faithful transcription of the typewritten original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

and seems to impart a sort of spirit of its own to the whole vicinity. Mrs. Baker seems to hold her own remarkably well. I think she is close to 85. Mary, like the rest of us, has lost her child-like and youthful brightness, but still retains a hopeful and friendly smile. Poor dear Alice was quite ill at the time of our visit. We each gave her our blessing and started for New Richmond, where we had a congenial visit with Andy Tobin and family. Leaving there after supper, we stopped to see Anna Ryan and her brother John, just outside the city toward Boardman. Here we found Scott Tobin, my one-time boyfriend, and wife Jane (Henry).

Thence we sped back to Monsignor Owens to offer Holy Mass next day--Feast of my dear Patron St. Bernard. Our chauffeur and associate whom Sister Mary Kathleen (Doonan) had sent us for the whole day, went on to St. Paul and the Orphanage. God bless them all. I had the privilege once more of offering the Holy Sacrifice where for the first time I had attended a solemn Mass--three priests--and that at Midnight. It was Christmas Eve in 1881 when with Ryans' roadsters and our new sleighs a real load of us started in the ten miles when it was 18 below zero, and before we got home it was 22 below. The ceremonies were beautifully inspiring. Thanks be to God! They have a fine school now where in 1886 or 1887 Papa and Maurice and Mr. Ryan, Matt and Peter Welsh and young Jim Pachingham broke ground for dear Fr. Kelly. How happy he was, insisting that we come down to Reilly's and have a good dinner. Tears of appreciation filled his eyes, more expressive than any words he could have uttered.

Later in the morning we went for a hike, climbing the bluff to the south whence is a surprisingly beautiful view, not only of the city itself and the St. Croix River, but of Stillwater and the new State Prison layout, with Mt. St. Helen in the distance to the right. I gradually recognized the hill on which we stood as one I had dreamed about, off and on, ever since I had left Yonkers, without knowing what it could all mean. It is quite park-like on top with a single grave and a flagpole, etc. We said the rosary together for the living and the dead as we peered down where it would be dangerous to descend, and went down the West side. On our return to the Rectory, we found Fr. Owens--Pardon! Rt. Rev. Monsignor--where he'd been most of the time for some weeks with rheumatism sitting with two helpless feet on a chair in front of him. We each blessed them in turn, someone remarking that a triple blessing ought to help some way. Well, Thanks be to God, he seemed